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Report Grades All 46 Amtrak Lines

New “Bicycle Friendly Trains” Report Grades All 46 Amtrak Lines

August 3, 2026 / Will Simpson
(<https://bikeleague.org/author/will-s/>)

On behalf of the Amtrak Bike Task Force, the League is proud to release *Bicycle Friendly Trains*: (https://bikeleague.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/08/LeagueOfAmericanBicyclists_Amtrak_Report_2026.pdf) a systematic, route-by-route benchmark of how well Amtrak accommodates cyclists and their bikes.

In the report, we scored all 46 Amtrak lines on a 0–100 scale, looking at the things that actually matter when you’re traveling with a bike: how many bike spaces are on board, what it costs, whether you need a reservation, how easy booking is, and whether the stations along the way can actually get you and your bike on the train. The framework is adapted from the



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city/CLT/Cyclists%20Love%2
0Trains%202025%20Report.
pdf)reports, which have been
grading Europe's railways
since 2021.

How Did the Rankings End Up?

The *Cascades* (87) and *Gold Runner* (86) earned the only “Excellent” scores in the country, with ratings in striking distance of the top-scoring railways in Belgium and Switzerland. The *Hiawatha* (78), *Pacific Surfliner* (75), and *Wolverine* (74) round out a strong top five.

Looking below the top five, there's quite a dramatic gap between the frontrunners and the rest of the country's rail lines. Two-thirds of all bike-service lines land in the “Moderate” band, with the average line scoring in the low 50s. And seven lines, including the *Acela* and the *Auto Train*, offer no bike service at all.

Despite the moderately low bar, here's the good news: this is a snapshot taken right

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are rolling out starting this year, doubling bike capacity on many routes and finally retiring the dreaded front-wheel-removal requirement. The *Vermont* alone is projected to jump 20 points once Airo arrives.

Read the report
(https://bikeleague.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/08/LeagueOfAmericanBicyclists_AmtrakReport_2026.pdf)

Who's Keeping Amtrak on Track?

Whether you're exploring the report or the accompanying map, it's clear that Amtrak's overall scores show plenty of room for improvement—and that we all have a role in making that happen. One major factor preventing more proactive changes is the fact that Amtrak owns just 13% of the stations it serves, 9% of the platforms, and 7% of the parking lots. Even the tracks themselves are primarily owned by freight railroads, with Amtrak owning only a mere 3% of its route mileage.



local advocates play a powerful role in improving bike-train travel. Look no further than the report's three case studies for proof of what's possible when communities refuse to let institutional inertia slow them down:

- In Anniston, Alabama, the city and a regional rail commission extended a too-short platform to connect the *Crescent* to the ~100-mile Chief Ladiga/Silver Comet trail corridor.
- In Davis, California, a university, a micromobility operator, and a joint powers authority built a pilot program that links your purchase of a train ticket to a free bikeshare (or scooter-share) ride.
- In Columbia, South Carolina, a small bike co-op installed wayfinding signs directing riders straight from downtown to the Amtrak station.

Instead of waiting for Amtrak's policy to shift, people in these communities took the initiative to make the train more useful for local riders, and we applaud their efforts. Making trains more accommodating for cyclists is a collaborative effort, and

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local organizations and advocates are key to accelerating momentum where it's needed most.

The report also includes the Amtrak Bike Task Force's recommendations for Amtrak (https://drive.google.com/file/d/19oYIfgzBVFHPLP7f-7QSUUvy3tTnbKMm/view?usp=drive_link). This year, our top priorities for Amtrak are to improve the reservation system, so it is easier to see which routes have bike accommodations, add service at trail-adjacent stations like Anniston, AL, White Sulphur Springs, WV, and Greenville, SC; and create a bundled USA Rail + Bike pass to make it easier for long-distance riders to plan and arrange their trips.

We hope you will join in this effort! We need your local



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with communities to create safe routes to trains, and to support

adequate funding for Amtrak as a key component of our

transportation system. Learn more about how individuals can

support this work by exploring the report's recommendations

for advocates, communities, and station owners

([https://drive.google.com/file/d/1GOcNvFUgbub774HuFj0Oiu7](https://drive.google.com/file/d/1GOcNvFUgbub774HuFj0Oiu7Mp8-V9taE/view?usp=drive_link)

[Mp8-V9taE/view?usp=drive_link](https://drive.google.com/file/d/1GOcNvFUgbub774HuFj0Oiu7Mp8-V9taE/view?usp=drive_link)) to improve bike travel on

Amtrak.

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EXPLORE THE MAP

If you love bike-train travel, you probably enjoy a good map.

That's why we built an interactive map on ArcGIS Online

([https://www.arcgis.com/apps/instant/atlas/index.html?](https://www.arcgis.com/apps/instant/atlas/index.html?appid=9995c5ac50384be78d48f2c09a48cfbc)

[appid=9995c5ac50384be78d48f2c09a48cfbc](https://www.arcgis.com/apps/instant/atlas/index.html?appid=9995c5ac50384be78d48f2c09a48cfbc)), where you

can see every Amtrak station across the network, and click

any Amtrak line to see its score and the full breakdown

behind it. You can also use the map to overlay long-distance

bike routes from Amtrak Bike Task Force member

organizations like Bikepacking Roots, the Adventure Cycling

Association, and the East Coast Greenway, and see exactly

where the rails meet the trails. The visualization also

displays the routes that make up the U.S. Bicycle Route

System (USBRS).

(<https://bikeleague.org/membershipdrive>)

“Bicycles and trains are a perfect match, whether in Europe or North America. The League of American Bicyclists has shown that measuring performance is a powerful catalyst for change. We are delighted that ECF’s Cyclists Love Trains approach has inspired this important benchmark, and we look forward to learning from each other as we work towards making rail travel with bicycles simple, reliable, and accessible on both sides of the Atlantic.”

— *Fabian Küster, Director of Advocacy and European Union Affairs at the European Cyclists’ Federation (ECF)*

“Amtrak’s Northeast Regional corridor is one of its busiest routes and runs alongside some of the East Coast Greenway’s most complete and iconic sections. The ability to seamlessly combine train and bike travel unlocks countless opportunities for both commuting and recreation.”

— *Allison Burson, East Coast Greenway Alliance’s National Greenway Director*

“When Amtrak agreed to work with bike advocates in 2013 to form a bicycle task force, there were real questions about what we’d be able to accomplish. Fast forward to 2026: cyclists can now carry their bikes on trains to virtually every major market Amtrak serves. Last year alone, nearly 60,000 trips proved it and that number keeps growing. Thanks to the commitment of Amtrak and its state partners, many new trains will have expanded capacity to carry more bikes per trip, and bike service is expanding into smaller markets across America. Integrating bikes and trains is more complex than it may appear. Since passenger rail is operated by Amtrak and state departments of transportation, which fund and operate regional train routes, one solution may not “fit all” train routes. It’s great that the League can coordinate and unify the needs across America.”

— *Champe Burnley, long-time former president of the Virginia Bicycling Federation (VBF) and Amtrak Bike Task Force member*

“Bikes extend the reach of passenger rail. As ridership continues to grow nationwide, the League’s Amtrak Bike



WHAT OUR PARTNERS ARE SAYING

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Task Force is making sure it's easy to combine the two. Even
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in South Carolina, where passenger rail is limited today,
those connections matter.”

— *Regan Freeman, Executive Director of Palmetto Walk-
Bike and Amtrak Bike Task Force member*

What Comes Next?

This report marks a milestone in bike-train travel, providing a quantitative baseline for assessing Amtrak’s current bike-inclusivity. The report is meant to help the Amtrak Bike Task Force and advocates across the country push for the changes that matter most, and we’ll be tracking progress as the network evolves. In the meantime, the full picture is in the report. Dive in here (https://bikeleague.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/08/LeagueOfAmericanBicyclists_Amtrak_Report_2026.pdf).

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